



2ND WEEK: **DAY 12**

Looking back

YOUR BABY TODAY

By now, you may feel that your baby is beginning to interact a bit more as you notice that they love to gaze at faces and enjoy watching you talk and smile. However, they won't be able to smile back for a few weeks yet.

“ For some, reliving a traumatic birth is painful, and you and your partner may need support to work through difficult memories. ”

Once the acceptance and realization that you've had a baby sinks in and you begin to adapt to your new baby, you may start to reflect on your birth experience and want to share with others. You will remember your birth story for the rest of your life and later share it with your baby.

Sometimes the labor and birth may not have gone as you wanted or anticipated. You may have gone over your due date and had to be induced, which may have led to interventions, an instrumental delivery, or an emergency Cesarean. You may feel some disappointment and be unsure why certain things happened and whether you could have done anything to prevent them.

Occasionally some women, and their partners, who had a particularly difficult birth experience can suffer from postbirth trauma. If the birth was traumatic and you feel upset and unsettled, make an appointment with your doctor. They will explain events that you're unsure about and may be able to arrange for you to see the obstetrician who cared for you during labor, or recommend a mental health professional for you to speak with.

If your partner feels traumatized by your birth experience and felt helpless during the process, they can also talk to the doctor or, if they prefer, to a mental health professional.

Talking to your partner can help you relive good memories and come to terms with the more unsettling ones. Your partner is one of the best-placed people to reassure you about how you managed during labor, and talking together can help you open up and express your feelings.

YOUR BABY'S SENSES

Your baby will focus on your face when being fed. They have been able to hear since they were in the uterus and love the sound of voices and music. They are startled by sudden noises but can't locate them yet. They can taste, love the sweetness of breast milk, and can tell if you've eaten